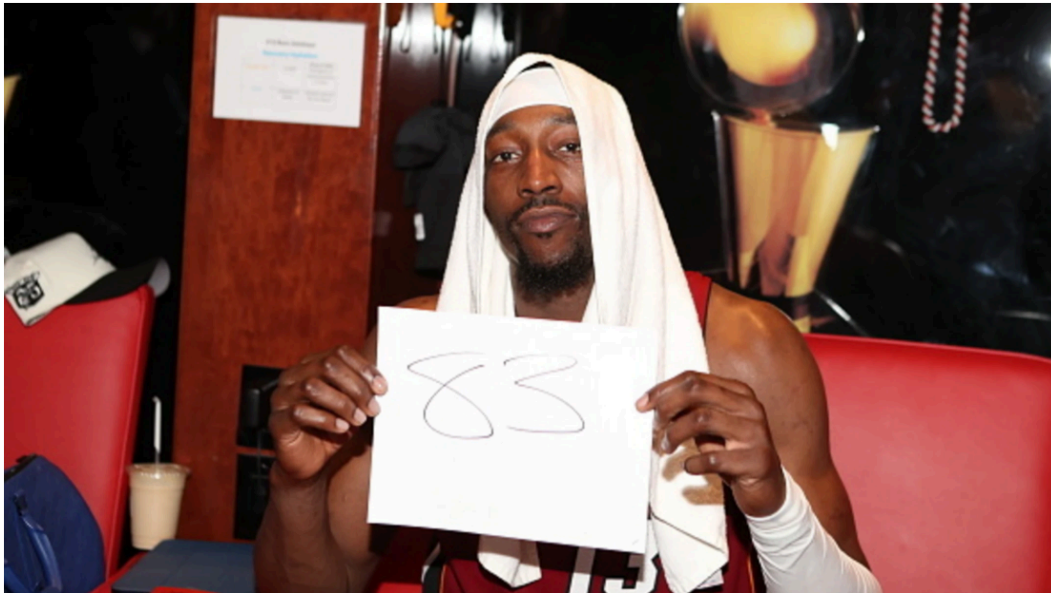


Bam the Great, or Bam the Fake?
Samuel Yepez - Sports Section - 2C



On Tuesday, the 10th of March, Miami Heat all-star Bam Adebayo scored a record-breaking 83 points against the Washington Wizards. This was a record-breaking performance that surpassed the late Kobe Bryant's 81-point game. For many, this was an exciting and incredible performance and well-deserved, but Bam, the coaching staff, and the opposing team are also receiving a lot of heat for his performance.

Fans and sports bloggers on social media platforms labeled it "unethical stat-padding" due to the 43 free-throw attempts and the game being a blowout. Critics do not respect the amount of free throws Bam attempted and claimed that the Heat were intentionally missing free throws, and then fouling to get the ball back to Bam and get more points, calling this stat-padding. Ex NBA players like Charles Barkley do not agree with Bam Adebayo's 83-point game. They think that scoring 83 is a complete and utter disrespect to Kobe Bryant. Chris Russo from ESPN also said that the Miami Heat's pursuit of the record was a "complete disgrace" to the game. Bam's averaged 17 points per game before this game, suggesting that he is not consistently a player to get this amount of points, and the Miami Heat played deliberately just to get him to break the record, not respecting the way the game is usually played, calling out attention that Bam should not hold a record over Kobe, who perhaps is considered a more all-time great player.

There are a lot of NBA players and coaches who disagree with the sports commentators and fans. Players like Draymond Green, from the Golden State Warriors, said that it is actually really difficult to get that amount of points, especially after getting 30 in the first quarter, and people should stop acting like he's cheating. In his opinion, Bam earned those baskets fairly. Giannis Antetokounmpo said, "In 30 years, nobody's going to remember how many free throws he shot," emphasizing that it doesn't matter what type of baskets he got, just that he got them, and that is all that matters when it comes to record-breaking. Bam's coach from the Miami Heat, Erik Spoelstra, said, "I apologize to absolutely no one. Period."

The debate about Bam's record amount of points is still being debated by a number of people. Some think his achievement was completely unfair and disrespectful, while others think it was legitimately earned. So, now it's your turn to decide, is Bam the great, or is Bam the fake?

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